

SOME NOTES

WHAT CANNATAIREACHD IS.

When Staff Notation was unknown, the MacCrimmons taught their pupils by a system of characters. There were various systems, the MacCrimmon system being the basis. But the inference is the MacCrimmon system upon which the others were based.

Canntaireachd is the vowel sound which is used to account for all the notes on the chanter in conjunction with certain vowel sounds. Other consonants are used to articulate syllables and in this way articulate syllables or beats on the chanter.

It might be described as onomatopoeic, intended to convey to the hearer the notes and grace notes makes when the chanter which should be distinguished to-day as one "syllable" which are "syllables." The inference is, that many errors in modern playing are due to this alone.

GESTO'S PUBLICATION

It is a pity that Neil MacLeod of Gesto published this as taken from John MacCrummen, his grandson, the late General MacCrummen. It has been a puzzle to many, and it is full of errors. It must be remembered that it is a verbal, and to reduce the sounds of the chanter to the greatest care in the recording of the notes. Realising this, therefore, we must be careful of Gesto's publication, for it would be a pity to have the tunes dictated correctly and consistently tunes dictated.

SOME NOTES

KEY TO THE SYSTEMS.

to the system itself, the following systems, Gesto's and Mr. Simon F. Gesto's, are intended to be used by Gesto and

GESTO'S				
Sound.		Letters.		Sound.
..	di	..		dee or vee
..	u	..		oo
..	i	..		ee
in high	..	ie	..	a as in ma
in far	..	a	..	a as in far
perhaps one	..	o	..	i as in high
of them yo	..	o	..	o as in not
..	in	..		een
..	un §	..		un

ems *u* is sometimes used for note E, when de
ced that many of the *hien* and *hiem* beats i
MS. not very clearly written, or printers' erro

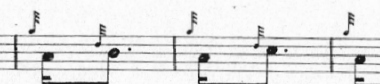
i or *vi*.

"i" opening most of the tunes
ded before any player breaks in
r note E in the text of a tune i
be the same as the "i" referred
or the same purpose as the "i" i

SOME NOTES

ceeding further, however, it should represent each "syllable" he tendencies, where, perhaps, modern use the time. This system, using is considered, a very sound method and, were it followed regularly cause for unfavourable comment.

SIUBHAL BEATS.



hin - do,

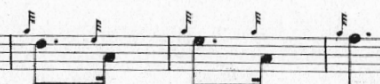
hin - do,

hin

hin - do,

hin - die,

hin



ha - chin,

hie - chin,

hi -

ha - chin,

he - chin,

hi -



ho - ho,

ha - ha,

hie -

hie - hie,

ha - ha,

he -



o - hin,

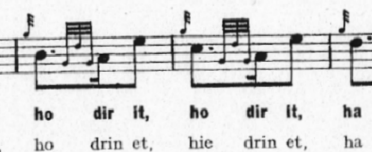
ie - hin,

a -

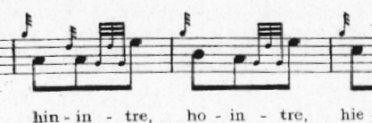
SOME NOTES

nt for Gesto's reason in giving L
iations ! Students will no doubt
point, which, after all, is per

uth beats are given with Mr.
a " t," which letter, Mr. Fraser s
! It is interesting to note that ho
unluth beats, Mr. Fraser brings i
of writing this beat.



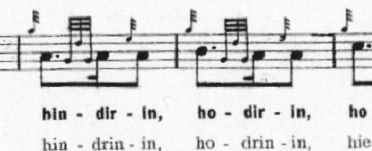
Fraser has what might perha
uth beat, which is as follows :—



utting " beats, also those belongi
school in the contention there is
the "back cutting" Taorluth)
grip, instead of behind it !

TAORLUTH BEATS.

osed Beat:



SOME NOTES

of Leumluth Beats, and students' discussions on the point.

"back cutting" scale is interesting today !

ished (?) beat appears in Gesto's Tune, appeared in staff notation before Taorluth, hence the reason for being

oted that Gesto has nothing to indicate beat, whereas Mr. Fraser's method

CRUNLUTH BEATS.

been some controversy, at one time to these beats in Gesto, but, on occasion to decide them. In fact, there are described as "Breabach" when on, as regards this tune, No. III. It would mean, in those days, so far as "outside," and certainly this has extensions on the outside.

analysis of *all* the Crunluth beats (writers' errors, etc.) shows that the book. Mr. Fraser has the anntaireachd, and his vocables are

ms in Gesto are as follows :—

yllables

out of the twenty tunes).

SOME NOTES

ables
(IV.).



Ho

Ho

ables
(XI. and XVI.).



Comment on the foregoing B

WRITING THE BEATS.—Special attention to the beats herein are written as re point of timing the beats, both tten. It will be noted the three ether Fosgailte, Mach, or the hree melody notes of equal time able beats (ending in *ti-ri* or ne value. This method of writi but is perhaps suggestive of son uth beats since the time Mr. Fr ange is very possibly the result endency is to rush the playing o merged into a series of grace not

Mr. Fraser was taught to sour rate syllable receiving its due is consideration, for it has grea the redundance or otherwise of a

e one in most common use to-day frequently used in Gesto. In it has been written as shown o syllable beat without the midd

urs in three tunes in "closed" V closed beat in Mach (Open) and E

SOME NOT

This Fosgailte beat in Gesto is will be noticed the other beats (the Variations are also four syllable, see Gesto's Tune X., where it is "Hin-to-rie-ri" and the close "ri" (as shown on the right).

seem a mere matter of fancy, depending whether or not the Fosgailte Crunluth is "open." In any case, it is entirely wrong form, after having played it in this is a species of "Mach" Variation.

to-day is to rush the second and give it the clear emphasis it should have.

appears in only one Tune (No. IV.) and is well known.

the six syllable open beat and appears in the same beat. The corresponding six syllable variation) is No. 5, and reference might be made to that beat. It will be noted both in the open and the other open.

There are only two examples of the same style is the same in both, but to indicate the form used when low G is clear in the next, as



He - drin - tre - in - de

Some doubtful Beats in Gesto

expected, there are certain Crunluth variations.

es for the Crunluth Fosgailte in the form is "open," *vide* the change in the

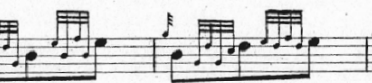
SOME NOTE

ended " Fosgailte beat, otherwise



- re - re, hin - da - te - re - re,

syllable Mach beat, Gesto's



dro - tre, ho - dra - tre,

back-cutting " beat of four syllables—



drin - tre, ie - hin - drin - tre

ended " back-cutting beat of s



hin - drin - te - re - re, a - hin -

somewhat similar to No. 3 but v
blings. Thus—



- re - re, hin - die - te - re - re,

seem that all the beats already
ple, *i.e.*, by playing a low A single
oubling " of the E. This would
Crunluth "fancies," and leads o
masters " played just as their fi

SOME NOTES

The principal source of argument is the present day
 is to-day often written as shown on the right.
 played this way. The late
 MacLennan wrote the beat as
 shown on the right, and
 thinking it is more logical than the
 sound of the other double beat.
 All these beats (apart from the case of
 the case, it is difficult to find
 the to-day of playing the beat on
 the basis of what is undoubtedly an
 old tune demands the three "syllables"
 to get away from modern conventions.
 In fact, there are tunes where
 the double beat would be more appropriate.

It is interesting to note that Mr. Fraser often
 writes (as shown on the right) with
 a big note and not a grace note,
 the birl by the present-day method
 of other beats.

Throws, Grips, Etc.



dro, dro, o dro,
 dro, drie, ie drie,

bie trie, tri, bi tri,
 be tre, tri, bi tri,

ri vi u, hie di ri vu
 ri vi u, he di ri vu

SOME NOTES

" beat (throw on high A) has been used as a double beat and also as a single syllable. The way of writing it as shown on the preceding page is, and certainly more usual! Most of the time, the first high A should be used in present-day practice.

TRANSLATION OF TUNES

the foregoing, the following translation of the tunes " Mach " and " Isabel MacKay "

PLAYING OF THE

n much controversy, at one time
d of playing these beats. Uph
ere is no middle A in the closed b
e Mach beats, whereas the old s

esh controversy has arisen in the
a demonstration in Edinburgh
s discussion was not free from bi
ittle logical argument. The demo
nothing, and was, so far as can be
timed, badly conceived and fruitl
at the discussion in the *Oban Ti*
us forming the basis upon which a
ould work and come to some de

s well to quote arguments which

the middle note.

al playing. Most modern players
was always played.

as written by MacDonald and M
efit of those wishing to produce
than the chanter.

MacKay shows no middle A in hi

t be played in time.

r of the middle note.

al playing. (This is, of course,
gainst, the middle note.)

MacDonald and Angus MacKay's

rluth Fosgailte beat contains thre